

University of Baltimore

III-2.3 Wireless Network Policy

Approved by President Bogomolny on 11/16/2010

Updated and Approved by President Schmoke on 4/24/2026

I. Purpose

This document provides policies, standards, and guidelines for best practices as they relate to providing and using the University of Baltimore wireless networks.

II. Overview

Wireless networking is an extension of the University's existing wired network infrastructure. It allows wireless enabled and mobile device users to access university network resources and the public Internet. The University provides multiple levels of wireless access services that provides encrypted over-the-air security.

To ensure the integrity, security, and optimal performance of the University's wireless network, the following restrictions apply:

Prohibition of Rogue Access Points (APs): The operation of unauthorized or "rogue" wireless access points (APs) or hot spots on the University campus is strictly prohibited. This includes any wireless broadcasting device that is not owned and managed by the University's Office of Technology Services (OTS).

Restrictions on Wireless Printers and Similar Devices: Wireless printers or any other devices capable of broadcasting on the 2.4 GHz, 5 GHz, and 6 GHz bands that are not registered with or approved by OTS are prohibited.

Enforcement: OTS will actively detect, disable, or restrict any unauthorized wireless devices found to be in violation of this policy. Violations may result in the termination of network access and/or disciplinary action in accordance with the University's policies.

Exceptions: Any exceptions to this policy must be approved by the Office of Technology Services. Users with specific needs requiring wireless broadcasting devices should contact OTS to seek approval and ensure compatibility with the University's network infrastructure.

III. Security and Access

The University's encrypted wireless services secure local over-the-air transmission, but should not be relied upon as providing a completely secure communication path. It is the responsibility of the user to ensure that communications, which include the transmission of personal or sensitive data, are also encrypted utilizing a secure protocol such as TLS (https). Data protection is the responsibility of the application and data owners. Users are responsible for protecting data on all devices.

The University's wireless services and supported security protocols may be found at <https://www.ubalt.edu/wireless>.

Authentication - Wireless users must login to either service using a valid University NetID and password. After three consecutive authentication failures, the device will be blocked for 15 minutes.

After the fifteen minute period has elapsed, the device is automatically unblocked. Verify the account credentials are correct so the device does not continue to get blocked.

Access Limitations - Authenticated wireless clients will have access to outbound Internet services, including MyUBalt and access to web-based email services.

IP Addressing - DHCP (Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol) will be used.

Wireless Protocols - The University of Baltimore provides wireless access using 802.11a/b/g/n protocols. Only the 802.11b/g protocols are supported on the crowded 2.4 GHz band, while 802.11a/n are supported on the 5 GHz band.

IV. Support

Personal device purchases, compatibility, configuration, installation, setup, security, and utilization of the wireless network are the responsibility of the user.

Support is limited to the network infrastructure and network user accounts. Suspected network problems and issues pertaining to network accounts should be directed to the Office of Technology Services Call Center at (410) 837-6262.

V. Users

Equipment - Users are responsible for purchasing and/or providing compatible and appropriately configured client devices and wireless 802.11 network interfaces.

Network Account - Users are responsible for obtaining a valid University network account (NetID) and password. All wireless access is authenticated. Access is available only to University of Baltimore faculty, staff and students. Special accommodations for guests are permitted through select offices on campus.

VI. Related Policy References

1. Code of Conduct
2. Acceptable Use of Information Technology Resources
3. E-mail Policy
4. E-mail Guidelines
5. Network Security Policy
6. Information Technology Security Policy